

Product Quality Perceptions of Chinese SMEs and the Best Option to Buy Quality Products from China



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I have 55 years of experience as a designer of electronic products for professional use. I have been manufacturing these with the best quality possible for our Indian and European customers. I have also been a buyer of components and equipment in bulk during my ten years with the government in Delhi as chairman of Electronics Commission and managing ET&T, central government's trading company. Quality has been my prime concern, and I have managed to imbibe quality as a work culture of the organisations I have worked for and its deployment in production and customer service.

I have had a chance to take a close look at China's SME sector when, in 2008, I travelled to China and visited 231 SME companies in seven urban production hubs

in China, and personally interviewed them. This was part of a project for India-China Economic and Cultural Council to study the growth and success of China's SME sector and identify reasons for their spectacular growth. During my visit, quality of Chinese products was the major aspect of the study.

What is quality

In the course of almost six decades in an engineering career, I found that manufacturers have varied perceptions about quality of what they deliver. Most of them relate to delivering quality that customers demand. Most, therefore think of quality as something that meets or exceeds customer's expectations. Others think that, even in a more limited sense, quality means 'meeting what customer will accept.'

Workers in an electronics factory in Shenzhen, China (Image courtesy: wikimedia.org/wiki/pedia/commons)

